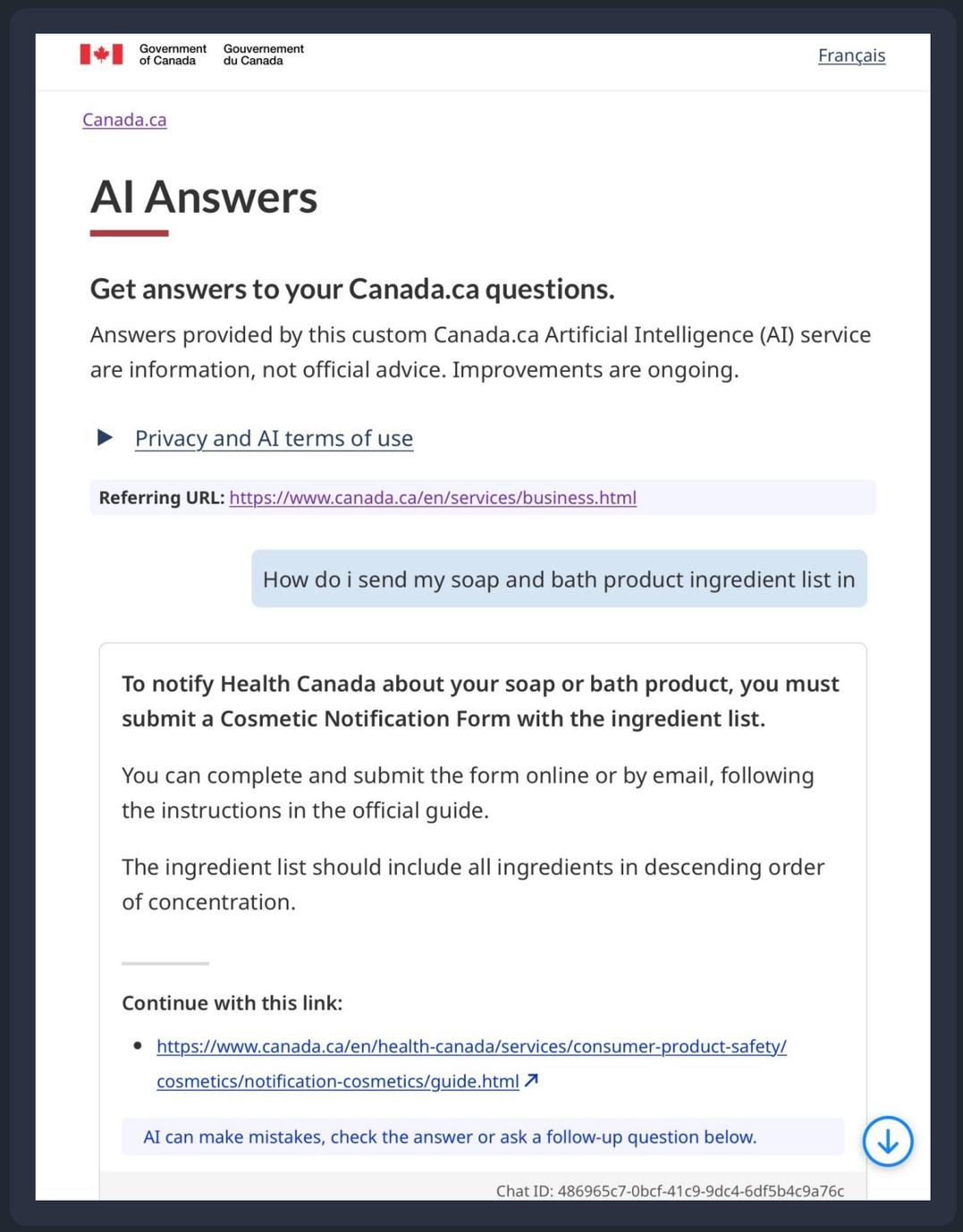
Canada.ca AI Answers answers are max. 4 sentences.

The design decision that keeps getting challenged — and the evidence behind it.



Model a conversation with a call centre agent.

— Answer questions briefly and accurately

— Ask a follow-up to get more detail

— Opens the door to voice delivery

Government has a long tradition of detailed written answers. That’s fine for documents — but Canada.ca AI Answers is a conversation.

Users are often stressed — especially newcomers and people with disabilities.

— Stress makes it harder to absorb information

— More words doesn’t mean more understanding

Web user: “I just find it too confusing, too much info all at once.”

AI Answers user: “It just went straight to the answer and I really liked that.”

AI can make mistakes. The longer and more detailed the answer, the greater the chance of inaccurate details slipping in.

Brevity isn’t just a design choice.
It’s risk management.

A short accurate answer that gets someone to the right page beats a long answer that keeps them from ever going there.

Short answers.
Clear paths.
Better service.

Designing government AI differently — based on how people actually think.

What’s your experience designing response length for voice or AI services?

#GovDesign #ContentDesign #AIinGovernment #ServiceDesign